would be quite a different matter altogether. The more you have, the more there is to maintain. Now that we had been given al the necessary money and freedom to proceed, I had to take my team forward and fulfil the promises I had made.

What would be needed to realise this missile programme, from the design to the deployment stages? Excel ent manpower was available; money had been sanctioned; and some infrastructure also existed. What was lacking then? What else does a project need to succeed apart from these three vital inputs? From my SLV-3 experience, I thought I knew the answer. The crux was going to be out mastery over missile technology. I expected nothing from abroad. Technology is a group activity and we would need leaders who could not only put their heart and soul into the missile programme, but also carry along with them hundreds of other engineers and scientists. We knew we had to be prepared to encounter numerous contradictions and procedural absurdities that were prevalent in the participating laboratories. We would have to counteract the existing attitudes of our public sector units, which believed that their performance would never be